already made a big enough statement by setting up the Central Bank of India; his deeds would have their echoes in eternity. Prayers were held for Sorabji's recovery, but the end was near. It came on July 4, 1937, after some twenty hours of near unconsciousness.

Thousands flocked to Buena Vista, his home in Worli, to pay their last respects to the man who had the gumption to create history and not merely follow it. Among the luminaries were Sir Phiroze Sethna; Sir William Lamond of the Imperial Bank; K.F. Nariman; B.G. Horniman; Sir S.B. Billimoria, and Sir Byramjee Jeejebhoy. On July 14, Sir Homi Mody, a Director of the bank who later became its Chairman over three tenures (1938–40, 1942–48, and 1952–66) presided over a meeting of Indian residents in London who had gathered to pay tribute to the man who had started out as a humble clerk but ended up as the czar of Indian banking. Sir Homi, called him 'great citizen of Bombay and India, a man of tenacity and resourcefulness, a born banker, one who had as an exponent of swadeshi broken through a field which had been the close preserve of the British, one who had started as an unknown clerk, and one who had been the first to conceive of a really Indian bank.'[31]

Tributes came thick and fast but it was a resolution of the bank which acknowledged perfectly the identification between the man and the institution he had founded and nurtured all his life: 'The Central Bank of India and Sir Sorabji Pochkhanawala were synonymous terms and the Silver Jubilee of the Bank which was celebrated last year was rightly regarded as his own jubilee.'[32]